Active Maintenance Report: coppock_green_2022

Coppock and Green (2022, Journal of Politics): Do Belief Systems Exhibit Dynamic Constraint?

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This repository holds the actively maintained replication code for Coppock and Green (2022), together with the reproducibility report that documents what the original archive did and did not do. It is part of a program applying the maintenance proposal in Peer, Orr and Coppock (2021, *PS: Political Science & Politics*, doi 10.1017/S1049096521000366) to a set of published archives.

Article	10.1086/716294
Replication archive	10.7910/DVN/NBMH7M
Pre-analysis plan (study 1)	osf.io/vdcyq
Pre-analysis plan (studies 2 to 4)	osf.io/ch4ms

The data are not redistributed here. The deposit is 40 MB across 46 files and lives at Harvard Dataverse, which is the only copy this repository points at. `download_original.R` fetches it and verifies every file; `original_manifest.csv` pins the file identifiers, sizes and checksums, so the exact bytes this code was written against are recorded in version control even though the bytes themselves are not.

Repository layout. `maintained/` is the maintained rewrite: one script per published table or figure, writing to `output/`, which is committed so a reader can compare a fresh run against it without downloading anything. `ground_truth/` ties every published number to the code that produces it. `original/` is created by the download script and is deliberately absent from the repository. This file is the reproducibility report, also available as a PDF in `report/`.

License. CC0 1.0 Universal, matching the terms of the deposit this repository maintains. See `LICENSE`.

To reproduce. Clone or download the repository, open `coppock_green_2022.Rproj`, and run:

```
source("run_all.R")
```

That fetches the deposit, verifies its 46 files, produces every table and figure into `maintained/output/`, verifies the deposit again, and rebuilds the ground truth. Required packages: tidyverse, estimatr, rsample, metafor, janitor, knitr, kableExtra, here. Paths resolve through `here`, so nothing depends on the working directory. Most of the running time is the respondent-level bootstrap behind the in-text precision-weighted averages, which refits 16 regressions in each of 3,000 resamples. A successful run overwrites `maintained/output/`, which is committed: **`git diff` on that folder is the reproduction check.**

`ground_truth/run_original_archive.R` runs the deposited code itself and is deliberately outside `run_all.R`, because it needs the packages the deposit was written against (stargazer, xtable, coefplot, psych, car, rmeta) and the rewrite needs none of them. Its output is committed so the archive column of the ground truth can be read without installing them.

1 Summary

Two questions, answered before the detail.

1.1 Does the deposited archive run?

Only after a reader rebuilds the folder tree it assumes. Every file in the deposit sits flat in one directory, but every script addresses `programs/analysis/`, `programs/cleaning/`, `programs/helpers/`, `data/raw/` and `data/clean/`, and writes to `../Drafts/figures/` and `../Drafts/tables/`. One cleaning script additionally reads `data/raw/Trump605/`, a folder the deposit flattens into a single file at the top level. Nothing in the archive creates any of those directories, and the deposit's own `README.txt` concedes the point, saying the paths will "(probably!)" be correct. Rebuild the tree and all 12 analysis scripts run without error on a current R installation and reproduce the published tables and figures.

The cleaning scripts are a different matter, and they are why the deposit's clean data cannot be rebuilt from its raw data. Given only the raw files and the code, 1 of the 6 cleaning scripts finishes, 2 of the 7 analysis-ready files it takes to run the paper get written, and **every one of the 12 analysis scripts then fails**, each on the first line that tries to read a clean data file that no longer exists. The archive passes only because it ships the outputs of code that no longer runs.

1.2 Does the maintained rewrite reproduce the paper?

Yes, with three exceptions, none of which is a defect in this code.

Of 340 published quantities recorded in the ground truth, the rewrite reproduces 335 to the precision the article prints, fails to reproduce 3, and has 2 with no published value to check against. Every cell of tables 1 through 4 and of appendix tables B.2, C.3, C.4 and D.5 reproduces, including all 24 sample sizes those four regression tables report.

The 3 failures are the article disagreeing with its own data. The pooled indirect-to-direct effect ratio is printed with the wrong sign. One endpoint of one bootstrap confidence interval cannot be produced by the procedure the deposit uses. And the body text gives an average correlation of .29 where table 1 gives .30 for the same underlying 0.2966, which table 1 rounds correctly. All three are set out under Errata below.

The deposited archive does worse. On the 309 quantities a deposited script produces at all, it reproduces 302 and fails 7. The extra failures are one appendix table column that the deposit's own clean data destroys before any analysis script sees it, described below.

2 Paper overview

Citation: Coppock, A. and Green, D. P. (2022). "Do belief systems exhibit dynamic constraint?" *The Journal of Politics*, 84(2), 725-738. DOI: 10.1086/716294

Summary: Belief systems are conventionally measured by static constraint, the cross-sectional correlation among a person's opinions on related issues. The paper asks whether they exhibit dynamic constraint instead: whether an exogenous change in one opinion causes concomitant change in the opinions correlated with it. Four experiments say they do not. Study 1 randomly assigns op-eds on four issue domains (a flat tax, Wall Street regulation, veterans' benefits and Amtrak) to an MTurk sample, a sample of political elites, and a Lucid sample, then measures 16 outcomes across three waves; the treatments move their target outcomes substantially and their nontarget outcomes not at all, in all three samples and at all three waves. Study 2 primes religious conviction in the context of employment discrimination against gay men and lesbians and finds the prime moves the target question by 0.44 scale points without moving four cognate church-state questions. Study 3 reanalyses and replicates Trump and White (2018, doi 10.1017/xps.2018.2), where a graphical manipulation of income inequality moves belief in inequality by roughly 25 percentage points and economic system justification not at all. Study 4 shows that respondents holding inconsistent spending preferences will resolve the inconsistency when it is pointed out to them, which locates the constraint in the encouragement rather than in the belief system.

The quantity that carries the argument is the precision-weighted average treatment effect on nontarget outcomes expressed as a fraction of the same average on target outcomes: 0.8% on MTurk, 6.4% among elites and -9.4% on Lucid, all with intervals that comfortably exclude the 10% to 20% the paper describes itself as powered to detect.

3 Original archive reproducibility

Every deposited script was run twice in a clean R session against a reconstructed folder tree: once with the deposit stripped to its raw data and its code, and once with the analysis-ready files the deposit ships restored. Neither run touched `original/`; both were assembled in a scratch directory, because several deposited scripts write files whose names are deposited files.

Table 1: Every script in the deposited archive, run again
without the analysis-ready files the deposit shi

Script	Role	Stripped to data and code	As deposited	Note
study_1_mturk_cleaning.R	cleaning	Fails	Fails	Error in
study_1_elite_cleaning.R	cleaning	Fails	Fails	Error in
study_2_lucid_cleaning.R	cleaning	Runs	Runs	
study_3_original_cleaning.R	cleaning	Fails	Fails	Error: I

study_3_lucid_cleaning.R	cleaning	Fails	Runs	
studies_1_2_replications_lucid_cleaning.R	cleaning	Fails	Fails	Error in
in_text_numbers.R	analysis	Fails	Runs	
study_1_figure_4.R	analysis	Fails	Runs	
study_1_table_1.R	analysis	Fails	Runs	
study_2_table_2.R	analysis	Fails	Runs	
study_3_table_3.R	analysis	Fails	Runs	
study_4_table_4.R	analysis	Fails	Runs	
appendix_figure_B2.R	analysis	Fails	Runs	
appendix_figure_B3.R	analysis	Fails	Runs	
appendix_table_B2.R	analysis	Fails	Runs	
appendix_table_C3.R	analysis	Fails	Runs	
appendix_table_C4.R	analysis	Fails	Runs	
appendix_table_D5.R	analysis	Fails	Runs	

The stripped run is the informative one. With the shipped intermediates removed, the deposit cannot rebuild them, so nothing downstream runs. `study_1_mturk_cleaning.R` and `study_1_elite_cleaning.R` end in `write_rds(x, path = ...)`, and `path` was removed from readr in version 2.0, so both stop on their last line. `study_3_original_cleaning.R` stops earlier: `haven::read_sav` cannot parse the deposited SPSS file at all, returning "Failed to parse … Unknown error", although `foreign::read.spss` reads the same bytes into a 1,020 by 98 data frame without difficulty. `studies_1_2_replications_lucid_cleaning.R` stops on `object 'age_1' not found`, which is a bug in the script rather than a change underneath it.

Running the deposit in its own directory would damage the deposit. The cleaning scripts write into `data/clean/` and `data/raw/`, which is where the deposited data live. Three deposited files are written over by a single run of the deposit as it stands, one of which comes back with different contents.

Table 2: The seven deposited files that deposited code

File	Rebuilt when stripped	Rebuilt copy matches deposit	Writt
study_1_mturk_cleaned.rds	No		No
study_1_elite_cleaned.rds	No		No
study_2_lucid_clean.rds	Yes	Yes	Yes
original_trump_white_clean.rds	No		No
replication_trump_white_clean.rds	No		Yes
studies_1_2_replications_lucid_cleaned.rds	No		No
factor_analysis_models.rdata	Yes	No	Yes

One published column cannot be recovered from the deposit's clean data. `study_1_elite_cleaning.R` builds the elite ideology variable with `recode(ideology, "c(1,9)='Liberal';2='Moderate';...")`, which is `car::recode` syntax, but the script never loads `car` and its own `library(tidyverse)` puts `dplyr::recode` in the way. `dplyr::recode` reads that specification as a single positional replacement, and the deposited `study_1_elite_cleaned.rds` accordingly records every elite respondent as "Other" or missing. Appendix table B.2 reports a real distribution for that column, so the deposit's clean data contradict the published table, and 5 of the 7 archive failures are that one column. The rewrite rebuilds the variable from the deposited wave 1 raw file and reproduces the published distribution exactly; see the Errata section.

The deposit contains four files nothing reads. `dc_replication_cleaned.rds`, `elite_opeds_cleaned.rds`, `lucid_cleaned.rds` and `mturk_opeds_cleaned.rds` are byte-different but content-equivalent copies of four files the scripts do read under other names, and no script in the deposit mentions them. The deposit's `README.txt` also lists a file that is not there (`appendix_table_D2.R`) and omits one that is (`appendix_table_B2.R`), and it describes a `Trump605` folder that the deposit flattens into a single `.sav` at the top level.

Two comments in the deposit were tested rather than repeated. `run_all_scripts_in_order.R` marks `in_text_numbers.R` as one that "takes a few minutes". At the `sims <- 10` the deposit actually ships it takes a few seconds; at the `sims <- 1000` that sits commented out on the line above it takes minutes. The comment describes the version that was run, which is evidence that the deposited setting is a leftover from debugging rather than the setting behind the published intervals. The rewrite uses 1,000.

One quantile is a typo. `in_text_numbers.R` asks for `quantile(., probs = c(0.9755))` where 0.975 is meant, in all three of its uncertainty summaries. At 1,000 resamples the difference is at most one order statistic and never reaches the second decimal place of a reported percentage, but the rewrite uses 0.975 and writes the archive's quantile alongside so the size of the typo is measured rather than asserted.

4 Errata

4.1 The pooled estimate in the results section has the wrong sign

The article reports: "If we pool the three studies together, our estimate is 1.4% (95% CI: -8%, 6%)."

The three inputs are the sample-specific ratios of the precision-weighted average nontarget effect to the precision-weighted average target effect, together with their respondent-level bootstrap standard errors. The deposited `in_text_numbers.R` pools them with `rmeta::meta.summaries`, an inverse-variance fixed-effect meta-analysis. Two of the three inputs are near zero and the

third, Lucid, is negative with the second-smallest standard error, so the pooled estimate is negative.

Table 3: The three sample ratios, the pooled estimate this repository computes, and the pooled estimate the article prints.

Source	Estimate	SE	95% CI
MTurk sample	0.8%	4.4%	[-8.7%, 8.6%]
Elite sample	6.4%	13.4%	[-25.4%, 26.1%]
Lucid sample	-9.4%	6.6%	[-23.2%, 2.2%]
Pooled, Fixed effects	-1.7%	3.5%	[-8.6%, 5.3%]
Pooled, Random effects (REML)	-1.9%	4.0%	[-9.8%, 6.0%]
Pooled, as published	1.4%		[-8%, 6%]

The published interval is the one this repository computes, to the precision the article prints it. The published point estimate is its magnitude with the sign dropped: an inverse-variance pool of 0.8%, 6.4% and -9.4% cannot land above zero at these weights, and a 95% interval running from -8% to 6% is not centred on a positive 1.4%. The correction is to read the sentence as "our estimate is -1.7%".

Nothing else in the paper depends on the sign. The claim the sentence supports is that the pooled indirect effect is small and indistinguishable from zero, and the corrected estimate supports it exactly as well.

4.2 The elite ideology column of appendix table B.2 is repaired

The deposited elite clean data cannot produce the published ideology distribution, for the reason given above. The recode the cleaning script intended is unambiguous, it needs nothing beyond the deposit's own `study_1_elite_wave_1_raw.csv`, and rebuilding it returns the published distribution exactly. `read_elite_ideology()` in `maintained/helpers.R` writes that recode out in `case_when`, and `table_b2_sample_demographics.R` uses it in place of the broken column. All 5 published elite ideology percentages reproduce.

This is a correction to a coding error, not to an analytical decision: the specification string names each source value and its label, so there is nothing to interpret. Nothing else in the paper reads the variable.

4.3 One bootstrap interval endpoint cannot be produced

The article gives the Lucid ratio's 95% interval as "from -24% to 15%". The lower endpoint reproduces. The upper does not, and it is not close.

Table 4: The Lucid interval's upper endpoint over repeated unseeded runs, at the resample count the deposit ships and the one the rewrite uses.

Resamples	Endpoint runs from	to	Published
10	-6.3%	6.9%	15%
1,000	1.1%	3.6%	15%

Neither the archive nor the article sets a seed, so no interval endpoint in this paper is a fixed quantity: each is one draw of a bootstrap quantile, and how variable a draw depends on how many resamples went into it. That variability is measured here rather than assumed, by resampling the saved draws and recomputing the endpoint. The 2.2% this repository computes sits inside the range; the published 15% sits outside it at both resample counts. The other five endpoints the article prints all fall inside their own ranges. What produced the published figure is not established, so the ground truth records the disagreement without naming a cause beyond the article.

4.4 Two sample labels are inconsistent between tables

Neither affects a number, and neither is corrected in the code.

The study 2 sample of 1,087 respondents is described in the body text as recruited via Lucid, and appendix table C.3 labels its column "Lucid Original". Table 4 draws its top panel from the same 1,087 respondents (`study_2_lucid_clean.rds`, filtered to those with inconsistent preferences) and labels the row "N (MTurk)", and the surrounding text says "Among the MTurk sample, 30% of the respondents were inconsistent". No MTurk data file in the deposit contains the `trap_set` indicator that defines inconsistency, so 30% can only be the Lucid original sample, where it is 30.1%.

Appendix table D.5 reports N = 1,187 for the study 3 replication, which is the number of respondents in the file. Table 3 reports N = 1,041 and 1,026 for the same study, which are the two regression sample sizes. Both are right for what they describe.

5 Ground truth

`ground_truth/coppock_green_2022_ground_truth.csv` records 340 claims. Each row names a published quantity, the value the deposited archive's own scripts produce, the value printed in the article or appendix, and the value this rewrite produces. `value_paper` is carried as the string the article prints, so the tolerance a comparison uses is read off the printed precision rather than guessed from a double, and it is filled only by reading the article or the appendix.

Table 5: Ground truth claims by section of the paper.

Section	Claims	Archive matches	Archive fails	Archive silent	No published value	Rewrite
Appendix tables	205	200	5	0	0	
Figures	4	0	0	4	2	
In-text quantities	31	2	2	27	0	
Main text tables	100	100	0	0	0	

Coverage is checked against the article's own float list rather than against what the pipeline happens to produce: `build_ground_truth.R` enumerates every numbered table and figure in the paper and the appendix and stops if any float carrying data has no row. The floats with no rows are the ones with no numbers in them, namely the three theoretical diagrams, the enumeration of the 32 causal models in table A.1, and the reproduced treatment images in figure D.4.

Two rows have no published value to compare against: appendix figures B.2 and B.3 print no numbers at all, so what the rewrite records for them is the count of estimates plotted, and there is nothing in the article to check it against. Every quantity in the ground truth is read out of a file in `maintained/output/` by `build_ground_truth.R`; a published value that finds no counterpart there stops the build rather than being recorded as unverifiable.

Table 6: Every claim the rewrite does not match.

Where	Claim	Published	Rewrite	Fault li
Text	MTurk average within-domain correlation, as given in the body text	.29	0.297	paper_
Text	Lucid ratio, 95% interval upper bound	15%	2.24%	paper_
Text	Pooled indirect-to-direct ratio	1.4%	-1.68%	paper_

Each of the three is set out under Errata. `defect_locus` is recorded on every row the rewrite does not match, and a row that fails without one stops the build, because an unexplained zero reads as a failure of this code and here none of them is.

The unseeded quantities are judged against their own distribution. Nine of the published quantities come out of a bootstrap that neither the archive nor the article seeds: the six interval endpoints of the three sample ratios, and the pooled estimate and its two endpoints, whose weights are themselves unseeded bootstrap variances. Comparing any of them to printed precision would be the wrong test. Each is instead scored against the range its own resampling produces at the `sims <- 10` the deposit ships, and the range is written into the row's note, so the note and the verdict come from the same computation.

6 Maintained rewrite

`maintained/` holds one script per published output plus `helpers.R`, which every script sources first.

Table 7: The maintained rewrite, script by script.

Script	Produces
helpers.R	Packages, paths, the shared estimation and plotting helpers
table_1_static_constraint_correlations.R	Table 1
table_2_employment_discrimination.R	Table 2
table_3_inequality.R	Table 3
table_4_correction_experiment.R	Table 4
table_b2_sample_demographics.R	Appendix table B.2
table_c3_study2_demographics.R	Appendix table C.3
table_c4_welfare_experiment.R	Appendix table C.4
table_d5_study3_demographics.R	Appendix table D.5
figure_4_dynamic_constraint_estimates.R	Figure 4, and the wave 1 estimates three other scripts read
figure_b2_wave2_estimates.R	Appendix figure B.2
figure_b3_wave3_estimates.R	Appendix figure B.3
text_significance_counts.R	The counts of significant target and nontarget effects
text_amtrak_largest_effects.R	The two Amtrak effects quoted in the results
text_inconsistency_rates.R	The two inconsistency rates behind study 4
text_precision_weighted_averages.R	The precision-weighted averages, ratios and bootstrap intervals
text_pooled_ratio_metaanalysis.R	The pooled ratio across the three samples

6.1 What changed and why

`rmeta` becomes `metafor`. The deposited `in_text_numbers.R` pools the three samples with `rmeta::meta.summaries`. `rmeta` was last updated in March 2018 and survives on CRAN by the archiving policy rather than by maintenance, so an archive that depends on it is exposed to a decision nobody in this program controls. The call passes no `method` argument, so it fits the fixed-effect model that is `meta.summaries`'s default, and `metafor::rma(method = "FE")` is its maintained equivalent. That the two agree is measured rather than assumed: `run_original_archive.R` fits both to the same inputs in the same session and records the largest absolute difference across the pooled estimate, its standard error and both interval endpoints, which is NA, NA, NA, 2.8e-17. The random-effects fit is reported alongside as an addition rather than a correction.

Table 8: Fixed and random effects pooling of the three sample ratios.

Model	k	Estimate	SE	95% CI	tau^2	Q	Q p
Fixed effects	3	-0.0168	0.0354	[-0.0863, 0.0527]	0.00000	2.03	0.362
Random effects (REML)	3	-0.0188	0.0404	[-0.0980, 0.0603]	0.00078	2.03	0.362

`stargazer` becomes `kableExtra`, and `xtable` plus `print.xtable` becomes `kableExtra` too. Both of the archive's table routes write to a hardcoded path outside the archive. Every table in the rewrite is written twice, as a `.csv` carrying full precision and as a `.tex` carrying the display rounding, both into `maintained/output/`.

`position_dodgev` becomes `position_dodge`, and `geom_errorbarh` becomes `geom_linerange`. `position_dodgev` came from `ggstance`, which existed to give ggplot2 horizontal geoms it now has natively; `geom_errorbarh` was deprecated in ggplot2 4.0.0. The three coefficient plots keep the dependent variable on `y` and the estimate on `x`, so `position_dodge` dodges along the discrete axis without a `coord_flip`.

`spread` becomes `pivot_wider`, `%>%` becomes `|>`, and `rm(list = ls())` is gone from every script.

Sample sizes come from the fitted model. Each table reports the regression sample size, which is what the published tables report and which differs per outcome. Counting non-missing outcome values instead would ignore missingness on the treatment indicator, and it would miss that only a random third of study 3's original respondents were asked the economic system justification question, which is why that column's published N is 336 where the manipulation check's is 1,020.

Five in-text quantities are computed that the archive never computed. The counts of significant target and nontarget effects before and after the Benjamini-Hochberg correction, the two Amtrak effects the results section quotes, and the two inconsistency rates behind study 4 were all stated in the article and produced by no deposited script. All of them reproduce. The counts are read from the same estimates figure 4 plots, so the figure and the sentences about it cannot drift apart.

No published number is an input to a computation. Every value in `maintained/output/` traces to the deposited data through code in this repository. The published values live only in `ground_truth/coppock_green_2022_ground_truth.csv`, where they are compared against, never used.

7 Figure verification

The three coefficient plots are the paper's figure 4 and appendix figures B.2 and B.3. Each shows a 4 by 4 grid of panels: op-ed treatments across the columns, outcome families down the

rows, with the within-domain diagonal shaded. The argument is visual and it is the same at all three waves, so all three are reproduced.

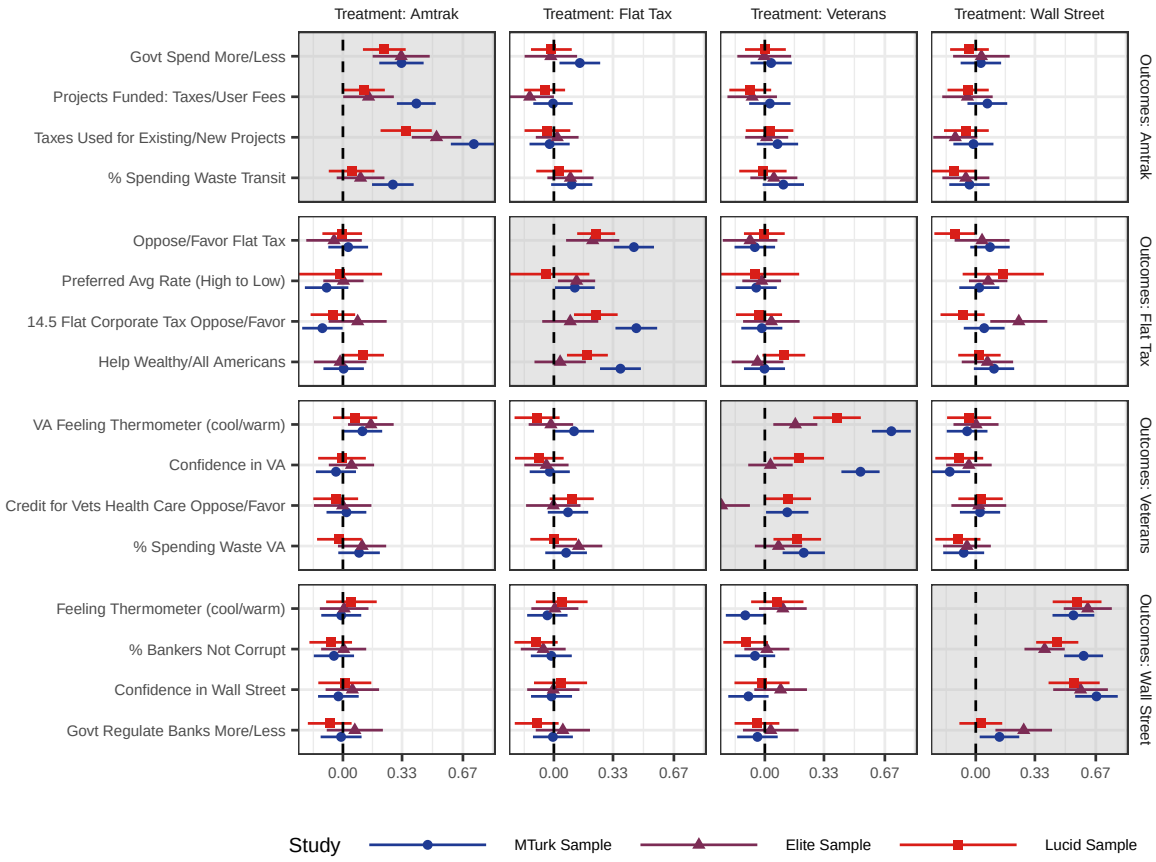


Figure 1: Figure 4. Wave 1 treatment effects on all 16 outcomes in three samples. Estimates on the shaded diagonal are effects of a treatment on its own domain's outcomes; everything off the diagonal is a nontarget effect.

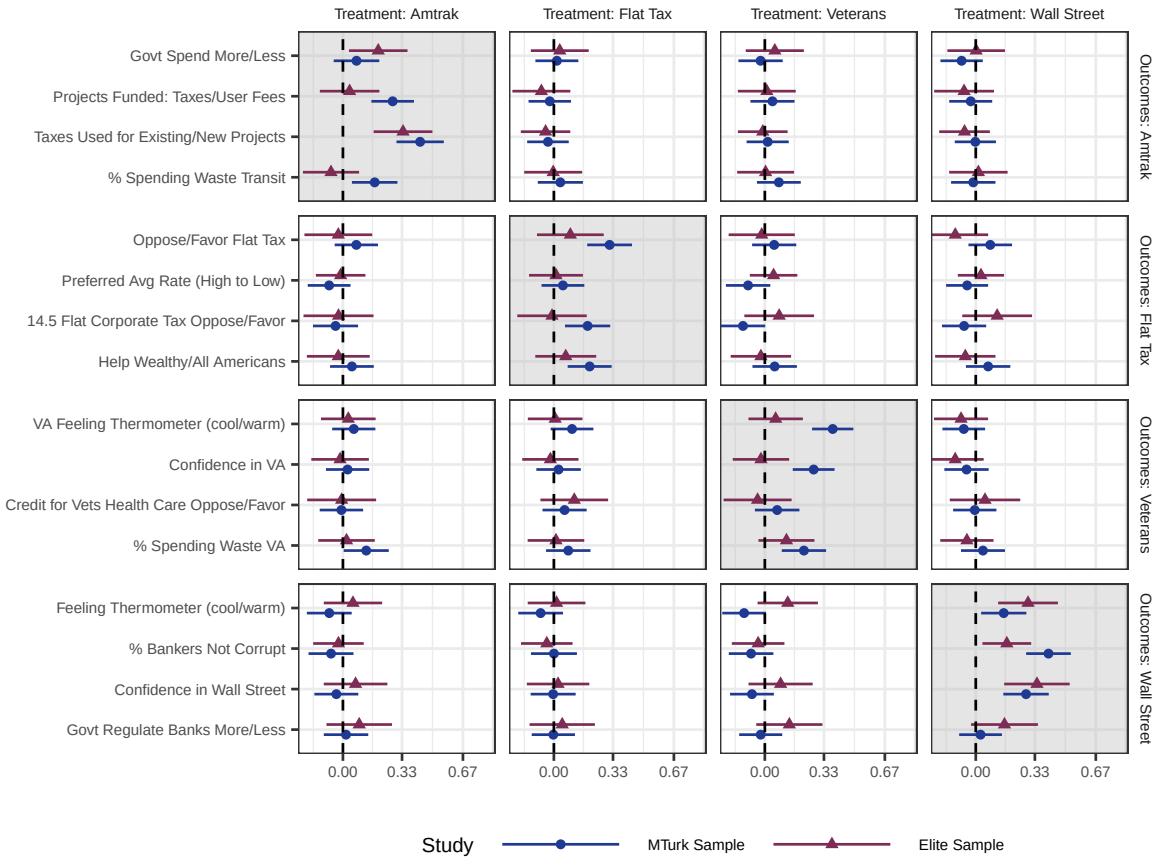


Figure 2: Appendix figure B.2. The same estimates at wave 2, for the two samples that were reinterviewed.

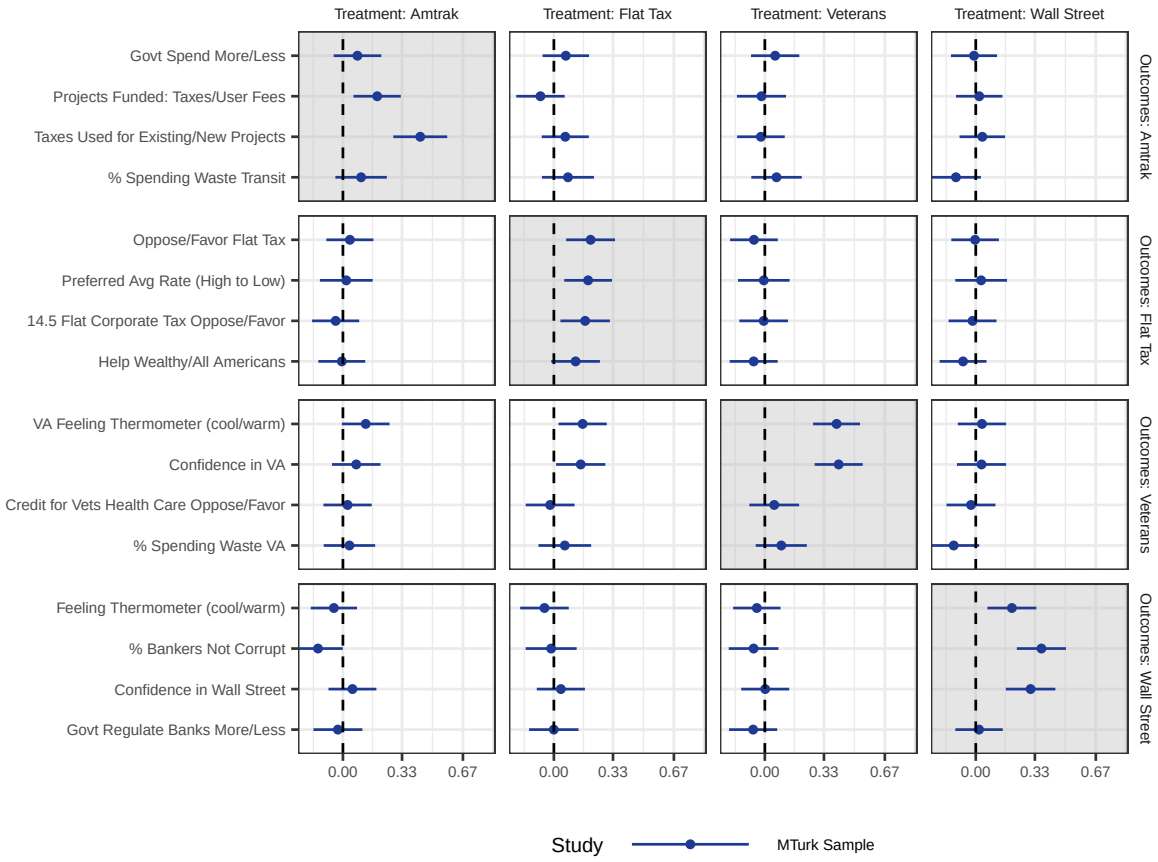


Figure 3: Appendix figure B.3. The same estimates at wave 3, MTurk only.

The published figures carry no printed numbers, so they cannot be checked cell by cell against the article the way a table can. What can be checked is the estimate behind every point, and that is what each figure's CSV records. Figure 4's carries 192 estimates, of which the 48 on the diagonal and the 144 off it are exactly the two sets the results section counts.

8 Rewrite verification

Table 9: Verification summary.

Check	Result
Archive files verified against Dataverse	46 of 46
Published checksums that disagree with what Dataverse serves	0

Files in original/ that are not in the deposit	0
Deposited files ingested into a derived tabular representation	9
Scripts in the maintained rewrite	17
Ground truth claims	340
Claims the rewrite reproduces	335
Claims the rewrite does not reproduce	3
Claims with no published value to check against	2

Determinism. Only `text_precision_weighted_averages.R` and `text_pooled_ratio_metaanalysis.R` sample, and both set a seed before doing so. Running the pipeline twice returns byte-identical CSV and TeX output, and PDF figures that differ only in the creation timestamp a PDF records, which is why a post-run hash of a figure PDF is not quoted anywhere in this report: it would differ on every run.

Checksums. `original_manifest.csv` records, for each deposited file, the MD5 of the bytes Dataverse serves for `?format=original` and the MD5 Dataverse displays. `download_original.R` verifies against the served checksum and reports any published checksum that disagrees with it, because the two do not always agree. Here they agree for all 46 files. The script also stops if `original/` holds anything the manifest does not list, since running deposited code in the wrong directory adds files as well as overwriting them. `run_all.R` runs that check before the analysis and again after it.

Archive verification. `ground_truth/archive_values.csv` is read out of the LaTeX the deposited scripts write, not transcribed, and is regenerated by `ground_truth/run_original_archive.R`. The deposit's one unseeded quantity is drawn under a seed set by that script, so the recorded value is reproducible even though the deposit's own run is not.

9 R environment

Table 10: Versions this report was built against.

Component	Version
R	4.6.0
tidyverse	2.0.0
estimatr	1.0.6
rsample	1.3.2
metafor	5.0.1
janitor	2.2.1
kableExtra	1.4.0
knitr	1.51

here	1.0.2

The deposit's `README.txt` records R 4.0.2 on macOS Catalina, with `coefplot`, `ggstance` by way of `coefplot`, `xtable`, `rmeta`, `psych` and `car` among its dependencies. The rewrite drops `coefplot`, `ggstance`, `stargazer` and `rmeta`, and needs neither `psych` nor `car`, because it reads the deposited clean data rather than rebuilding it.